

AI FAQ Assistant AI - AI-powered FAQ and customer support automation.

Description:

The AI FAQ Assistant is a robust, secure, and intelligent REST API platform designed to streamline FAQ creation, user authentication, and AI-powered content management. Built with Node.js and Express.js, the application utilizes MongoDB as its primary data store along with Mongoose ODM for elegant data modeling and schema validation.

Security is central to the architecture, implementing JWT (JSON Web Tokens) for stateless user sessions and route guarding alongside bcrypt for strong password encryption. The backend handles intensive operations like automated FAQ generation, semantic search queries, and dynamic context parsing. It also features robust centralized error handling and response status sanitization to prevent unhandled database leakage and ensure operational durability.

Scenario-Based Case Study

Background

BHARAT.R is a customer support operations manager who handles massive backlogs of repetitive user inquiries but struggles to organize entries, classify topics, write precise summaries, and track client question trends efficiently.

Problem

- Difficulty generating and maintaining up-to-date documentation workflows.
- Limited visibility into semantic search match keywords and rapid query resolutions.
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- Time-consuming manual processes for drafting complex support answers.
- Lack of unified database permission layers protecting private documentation from public adjustments.

Solution

The AI FAQ Assistant backend delivers a centralized, secure API wrapper that decouples application business logic from frontend delivery systems. It introduces internal verification matrices controlling specialized services for content creation, category keywords, database persistence, and automated text inference modules.

Usage

- **Authenticated Creator Usage:** Registers profiles, requests instant AI assistance, drafts official FAQ schemas, and updates or removes self- authored records.

- Public/Consumer Usage: Queries general list routes to consume published articles and issues localized semantic queries via parameters.

Outcome

By offloading workflow controls to a robust backend, operational delays are minimized. Data structural integrity is strictly maintained through automated schema validation, security tokens guarantee that only original authors modify documents, and high-performance indexing facilitates real-time data discoverability.

1. Software Requirements

- Operating System: Windows 11, macOS, or Linux (supports cross- platform operations).
- Node.js (v18 or above): Runtime ecosystem running server logic and routing infrastructure.
- npm (v9 or above): Node package manager to control operational dependencies.
- Express.js (v4/v5 Ecosystem): Lightweight routing web framework to construct backend RESTful entry points.

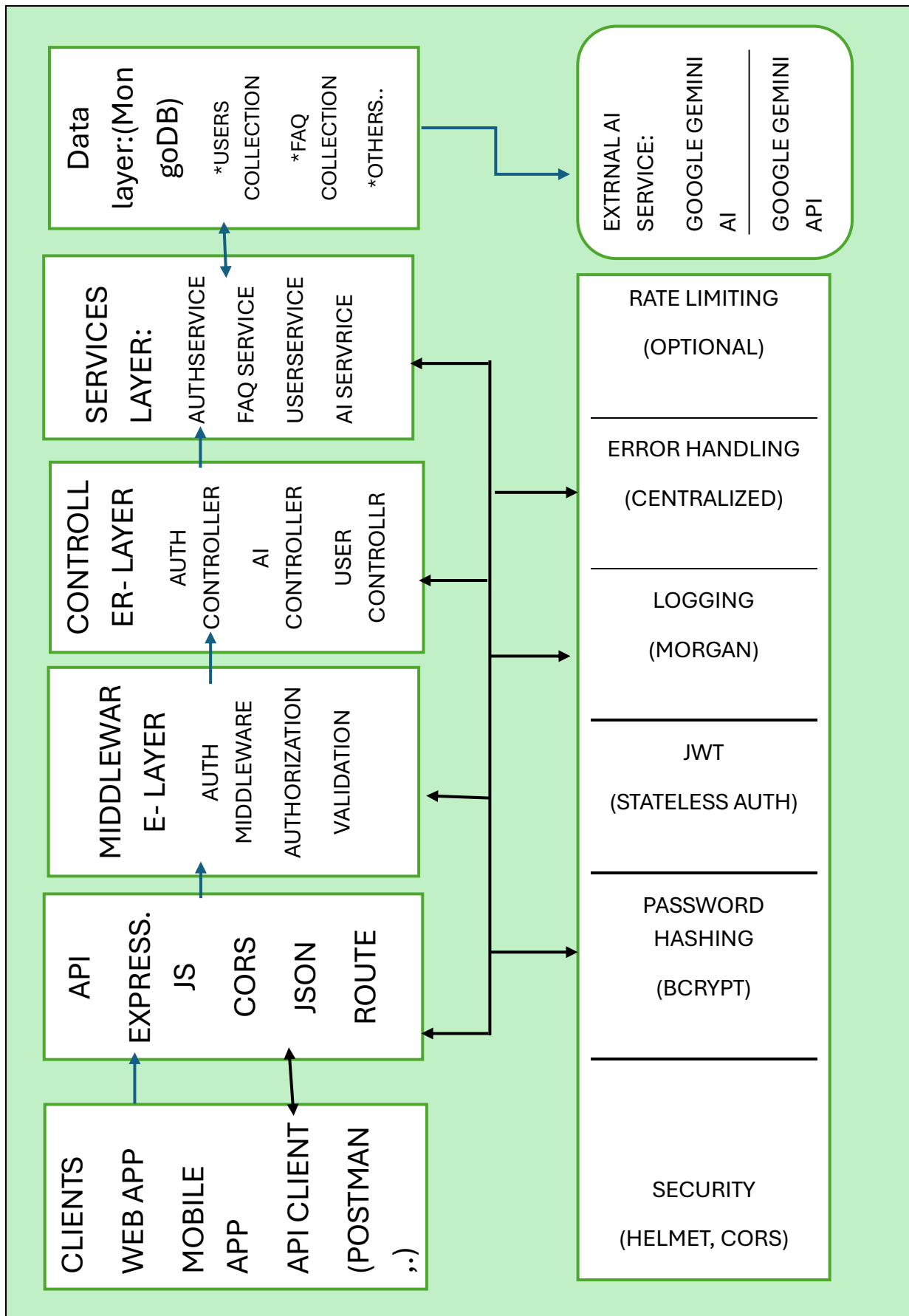
- MongoDB / Mongoose ODM: Document NoSQL engine storing application users and curated data entities.
- Postman / ThunderClient: API verification toolkit to assert schema
- validation responses across administrative route shields. Code Editor: Visual Studio Code or similar IDE environment.

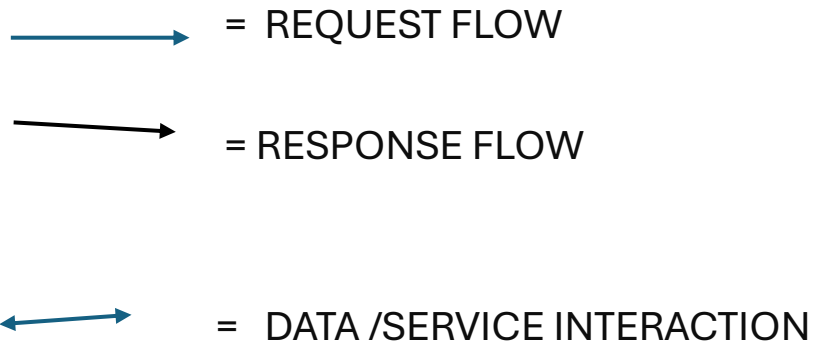
2. Hardware Requirements

- Processor: Intel Core i5 (8th Gen or above) / AMD Ryzen 5 or equivalent.
- RAM: 8 GB minimum (16 GB recommended for concurrent instances of MongoDB processing layers).
- Storage: 1 GB of available disk workspace

EPIC-1 PROJECT ARCHITECTUER:

AI FAQ Assistant API - Technical Architecture





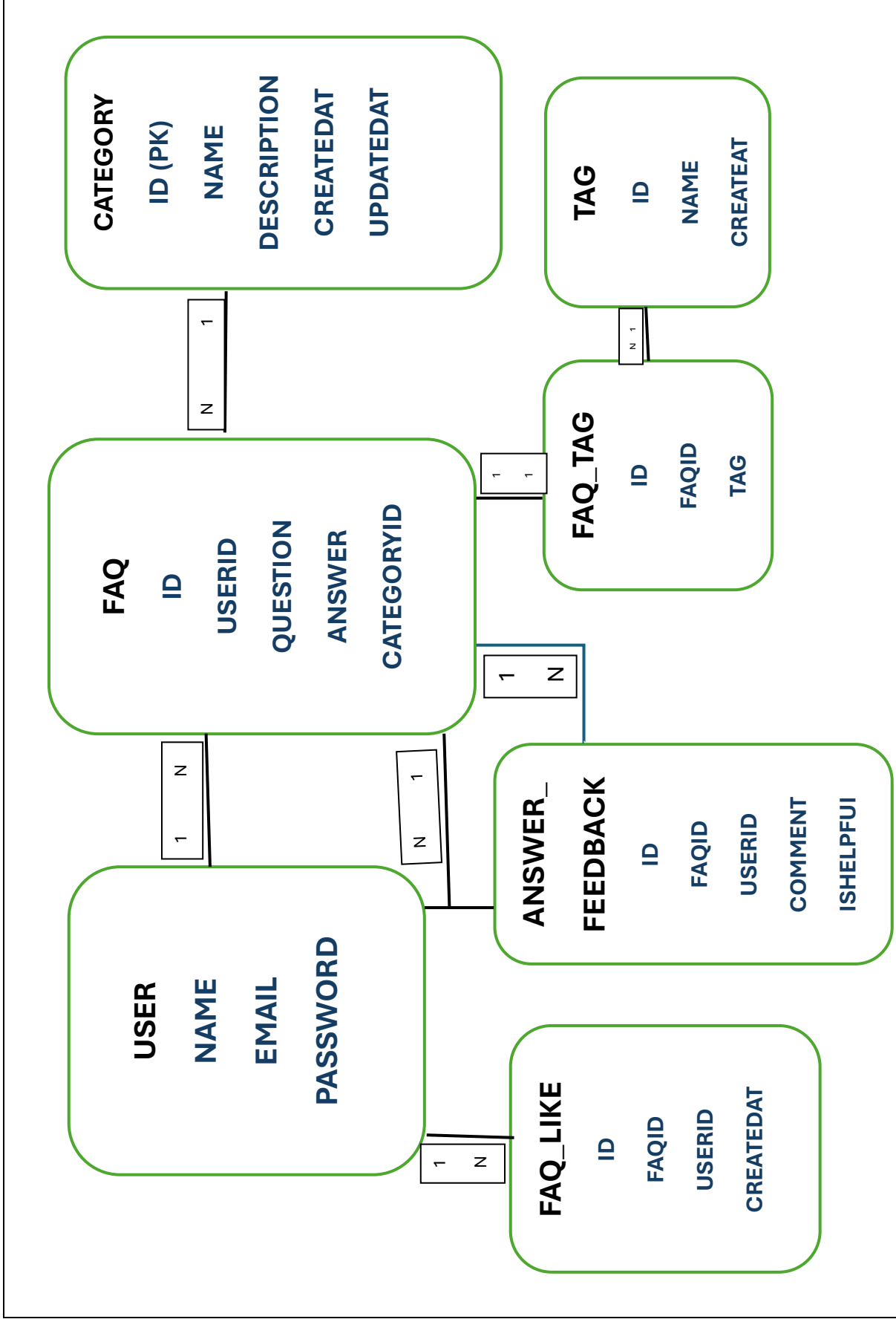
The AI FAQ Assistant application exposes structured endpoints handled by a layered server architecture model. Incoming requests undergo filter processing before interacting with data services.

Components Definition

- Interface: API tools like Postman query distinct route paths to extract JSON entities
- Express Server Gateway: Monitors network ports, maps explicit HTTP methods (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE), parses incoming JSON payloads, and handles CORS headers.

- Authentication Middleware: Extracts tokens from headers, validates user context signatures, and evaluates authorization thresholds for guarded resource paths.
- Granular Services (Logic Modules): Enforces isolated domain rules for user.
- session life cycles and operational query modifications.
- Database Interface Layer: Mongoose translates operational application logic into performant native MongoDB queries.
- AI Flow (Service Integration): Connected to external AI models via Google Gemini SDK integrations, letting the controller layer offload complex question-answering tasks and automated topic generation workflows.

Entity-Relationship (ER) Diagram Description



CARDINALIT LEGEND

1 = ONE

2 = MANY

ENTITY DESCRIPTIONS

USER: Stores registered user(admin/creator/reader).

FAQ: Stores frequently asked question and their answers.

CATEGORY: Stores FAQ categories for better organization.

TAG: Stores tags/keywords for FAQs.

FAQ_TAG: Junction table for many-to-many relationship between FAQ and TAG.

FAQ_LIKE: Stores likes on FAQs by users.

ANSWER_FEEDBACK: Stores feedback on FAQ answers (helpful or not).

RELATIONSHIP SUMMARY

- USER 1-NFAQ
A user can create multiple FAQs.
- CATEGORY 1- NFAQ
A category can have multiple likes.
- FAQ 1 – N FAQ_LIKE
A FAQ can receive multiple FAQs.
- USER 1-N FAQ_LIKN
A user can like multiple FAQs.
- FAQ 1-N ANSWER_FEEDBACK
A FAQ can have multiple feedback.
- User 1- N ANSWER FEEDBACK
A user can provide feedback on multiple FAQs.
- FAQ 1- N FAQ_TAG
A FAQ can have multiple tags.
- Tag 1- N FAQ_TAG
A tag can be used in multiple FAQs.

The backend database consists of multiple MongoDB collections connected through logical references to maintain user authentication, FAQ management, AI-generated content, and category organization.

1. User Entity:

_id (Primary Key - Objected)

name (String, Required)

email (String, Required, Unique)

password (String, Hashed, Required)

role (String, Default: "user")

created At

updated At

2. FAQ Entity:

_id (Primary Key - Objected)

question (String, Required)

answer (String, Required)

category (String, Required)

created By (Foreign Key referencing User Collection)

created At

updated At

3. AI Generation Entity (Logical):

(Generated dynamically using Google Gemini AI before persistence.)

topic (String)

generated Question (String)

generated Answer (String)

generated Category (String)

generated At

4. Category Entity (Logical):

category Name (String)

description (String)

total FAQs (Number)

Key Structural Mappings

User → FAQ (One-to-Many): A registered user can create and manage multiple FAQ records.

Category → FAQ (One-to-Many):

Each category can contain multiple FAQ documents.

User → AI Generated FAQ (One-to-Many): A user can generate multiple AI-assisted FAQs, which may later be saved into the FAQ collection.

FAQ → Search Results (Logical Relationship):

Search queries retrieve matching FAQ documents using keyword and semantic matching.

Key Features:

- **JWT Authentication & Authorization:** Secure token-based authentication protects private API endpoints.
- **AI FAQ Generation:** Google Gemini AI automatically generates questions, answers, and topic suggestions.
- **Semantic FAQ Search:** Intelligent keyword-based search enables faster information retrieval.
- **Complete CRUD Operations:** Create, Read, Update, and Delete FAQ records.
- **Category Management:** Organizes FAQs into structured categories for easier navigation.
- **Password Encryption:** User passwords are securely hashed using bcrypt before storage.

- Schema Validation: Mongoose validation ensures data integrity before database persistence.
 - RESTful API Architecture: Modular Express.js routes provide scalable backend services.
 - MongoDB Integration: Efficient NoSQL document storage using Mongoose ODM.
-

Roles and Responsibilities

Admin

- Manage all registered users.
- View, update, and delete any FAQ.
- Monitor AI-generated content.
- Manage FAQ categories.
- Access complete system functionality.

Content Creator

- Create new FAQs.

- Edit personal FAQ records.
- Delete owned FAQs.
- Generate FAQs using AI.
- Organize FAQs under categories.

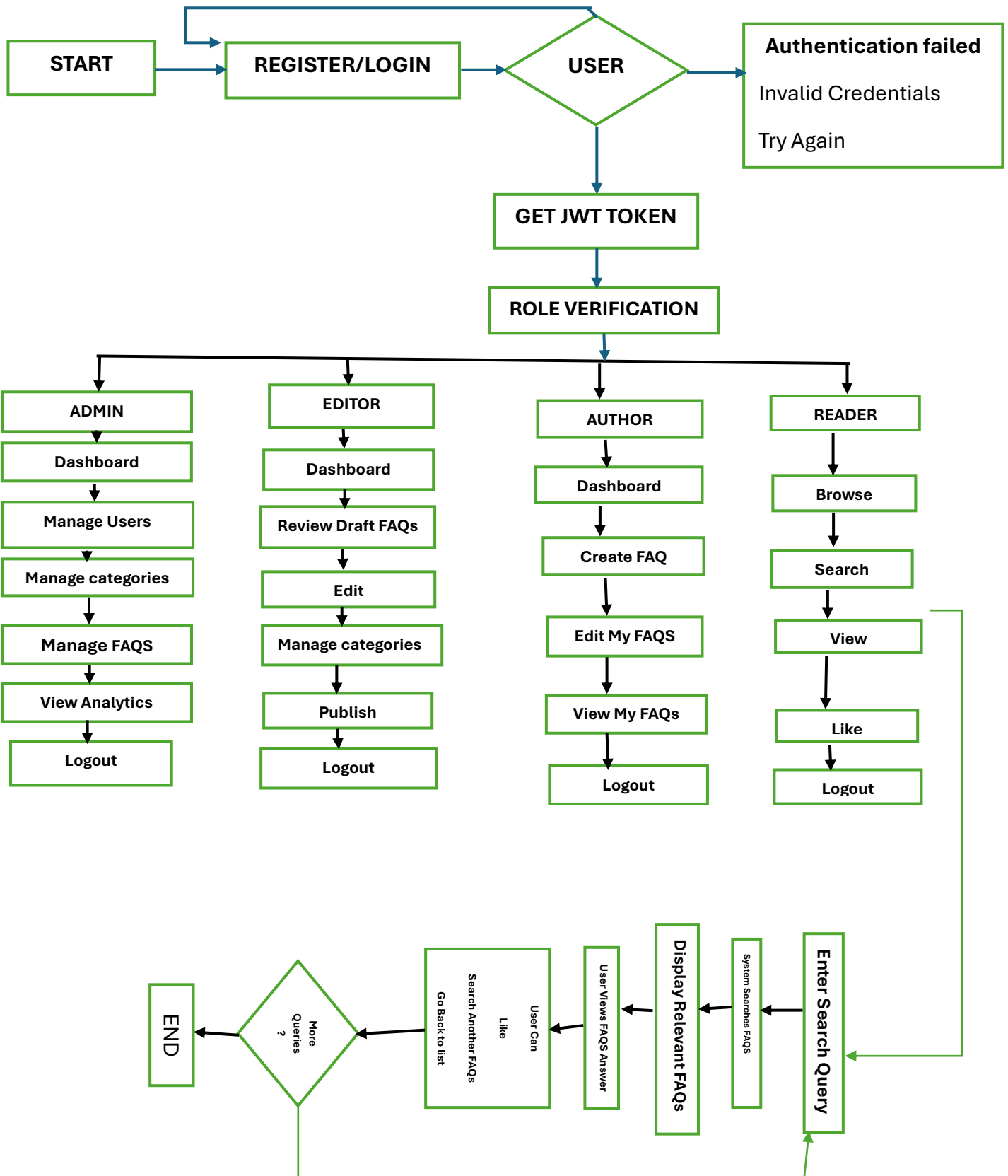
Authenticated User

- View public FAQs.
- Search FAQs using keywords.
- Generate AI-assisted answers.
- Access personal profile information.

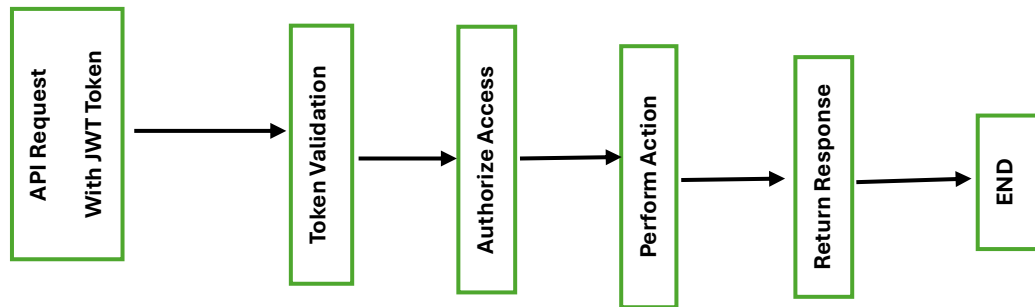
Public User

- View published FAQs.
- Search FAQs.
- Cannot create, edit, or delete FAQ records.
- No access to protected API endpoints.

USER FLOW

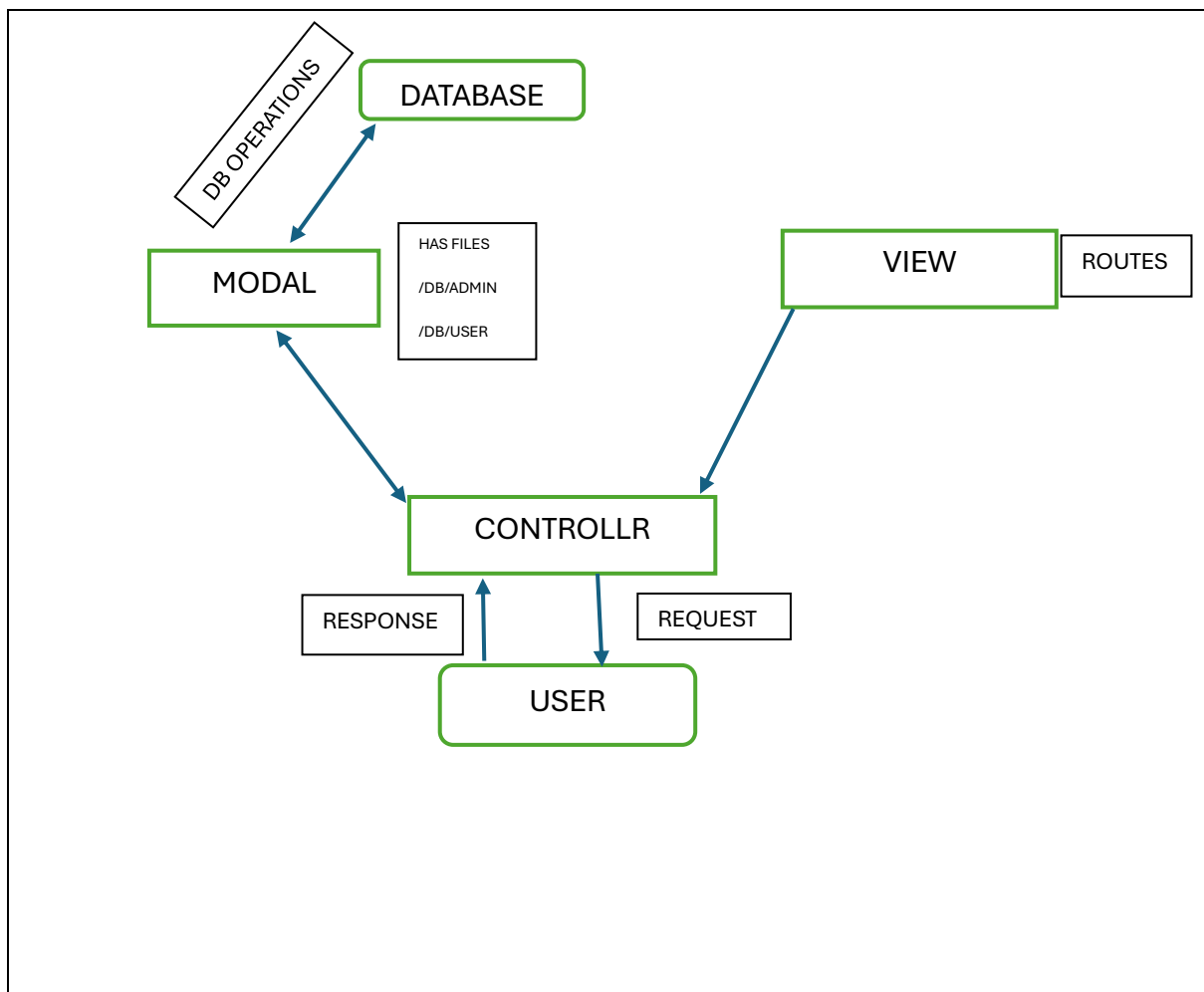


COMMON FLOW (APPLIES TO ALL AUTHENTICATED USERS)



MVC Architecture Pattern

The system architecture structures its source configuration layers around the Model-View-Controller design pattern to completely decouple components:



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Model Layer (Data Blueprint)

Defines structural blueprints via strongly enforced Mongoose schemas mapping explicit fields into raw collection items inside MongoDB. It sets field rules and defaults before validation persistence occurs.

Controller Layer (Execution Matrix)

The intermediary brain of the ecosystem. It captures request vectors from execution routes, checks structural request constraints, delegates processing workflows directly to models or services, and packages resultant output into standard JSON return arrays.

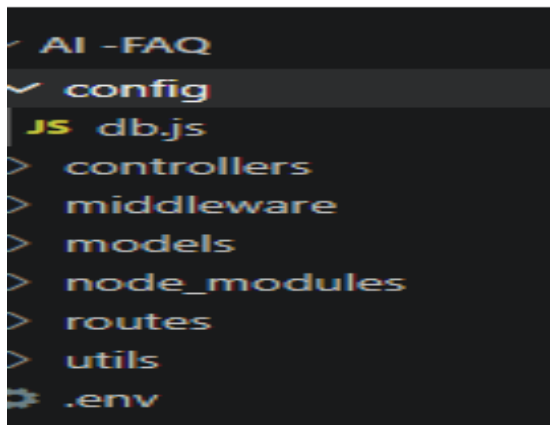
View Layer (Routing Network Interface)

In this pure headless backend service context, standard user-interface template views do not exist. Instead, the interface layer lives as an API Routing Layer. It links network requests on specified paths directly to their associated controller handler logic maps.

Epic 2: Project Setup and Configuration

Creating Project Folder

1. Create a new folder with your <project name>.
2. Inside that folder, create a new subfolder named src.
3. Now open that folder in VS Code.



Server Setup (npm init)

Open your root folder terminal in VS Code and run:

Bash

Step 1:

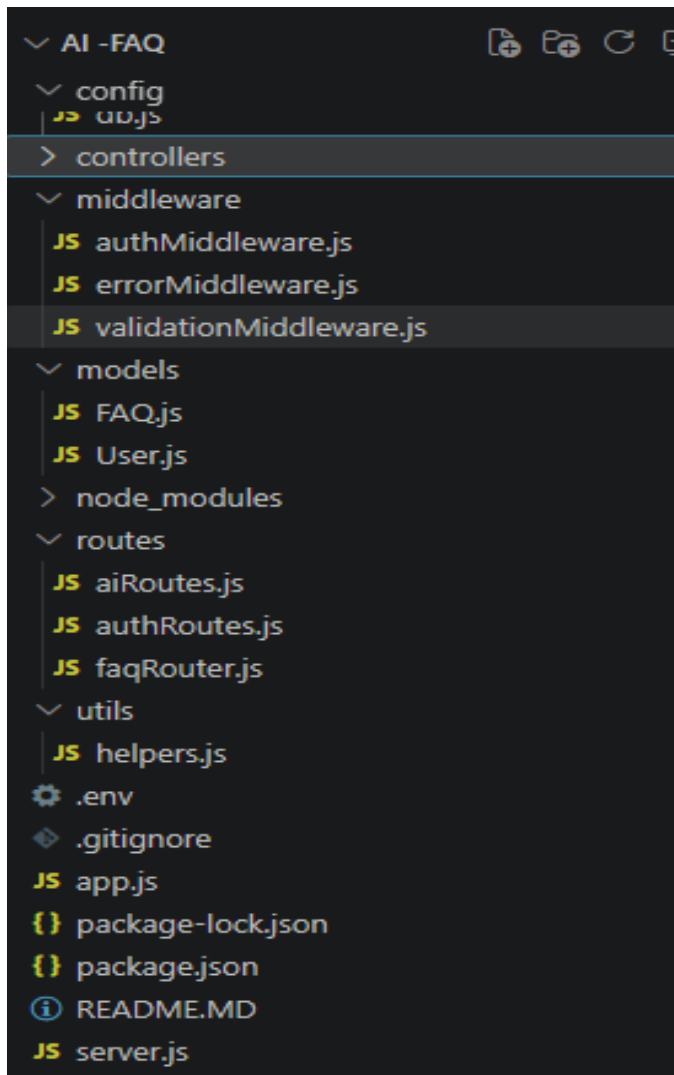
```
npm init -y
```

step 2:

npm install express mongoose dotenv cors jsonwebtoken bcrypt

@google/genai

File and Folder Structure Matrix Plaintext

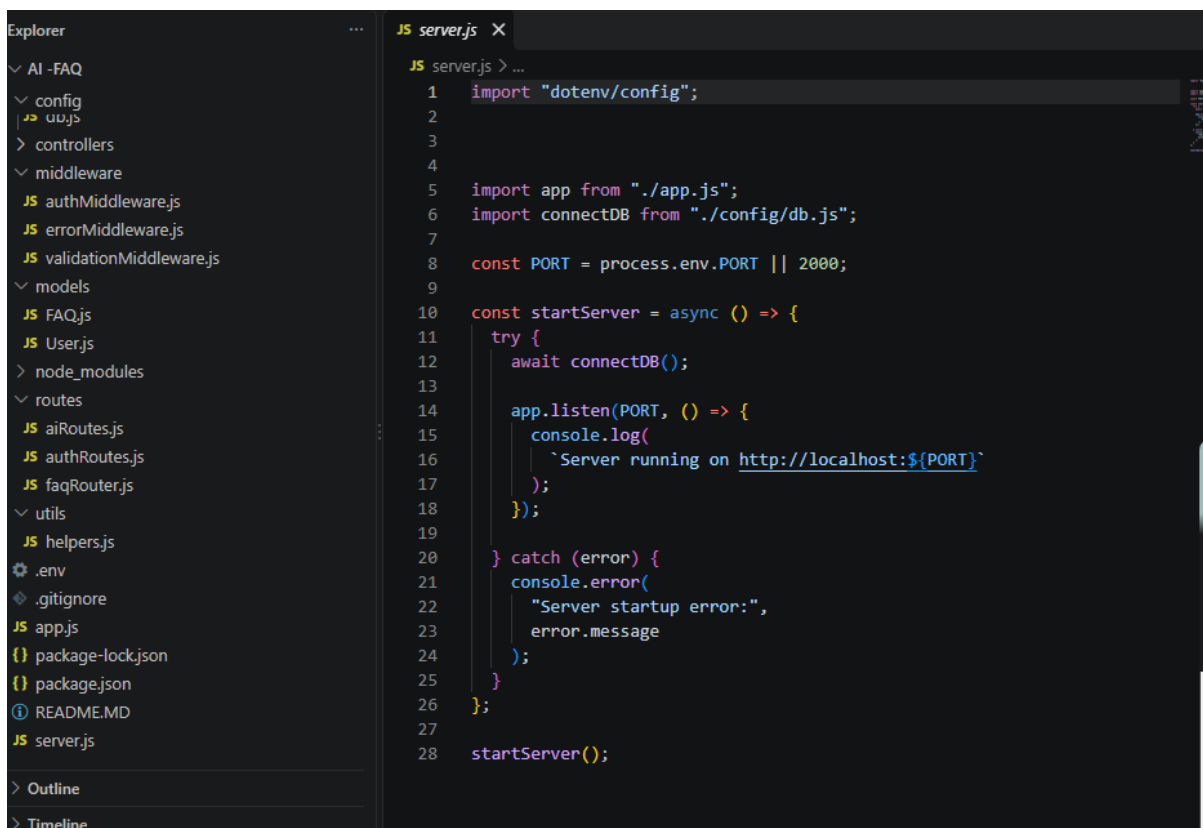


Epic 3: Backend Development

Core System Script Implementations

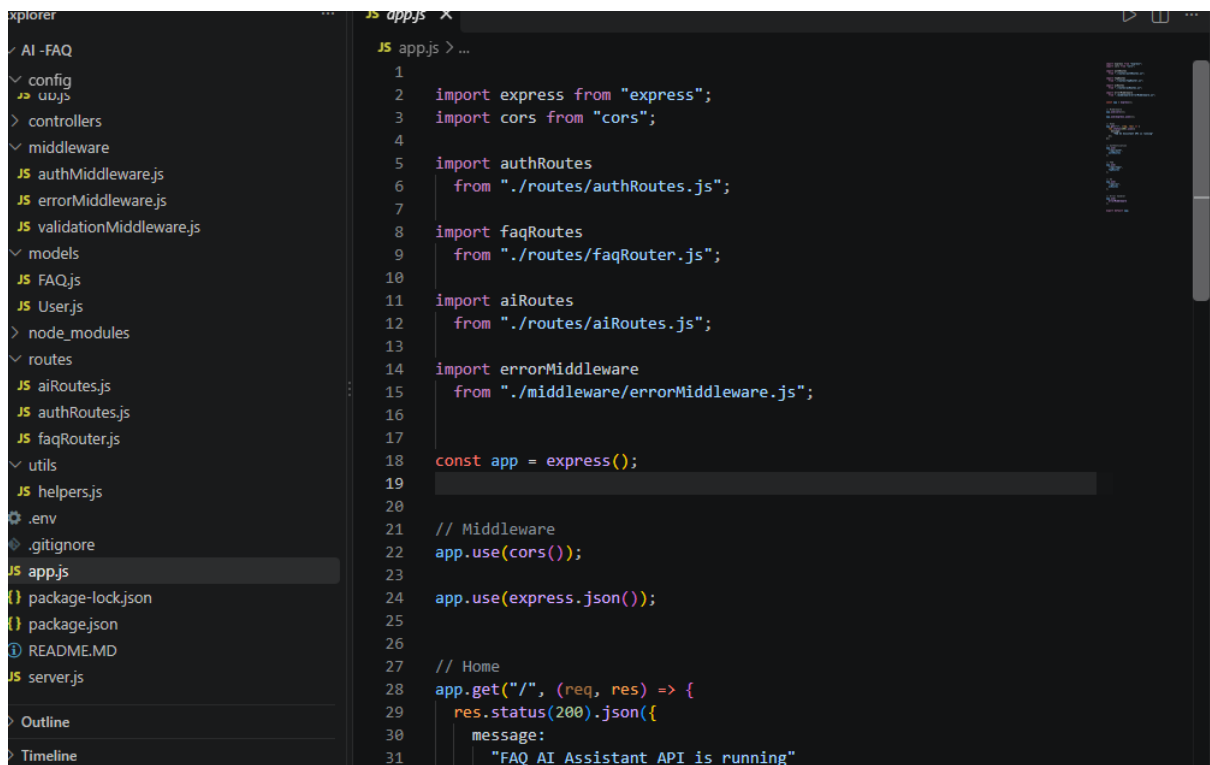
1. Gateway Server Node (src/server.js)

This main entrance mechanism aggregates environment variables, triggers database listeners, and binds network listeners to active environment ports:



```
JS server.js > ...
1  import "dotenv/config";
2
3
4
5  import app from "./app.js";
6  import connectDB from "./config/db.js";
7
8  const PORT = process.env.PORT || 2000;
9
10 const startServer = async () => {
11   try {
12     await connectDB();
13
14     app.listen(PORT, () => {
15       console.log(
16         `Server running on http://localhost:${PORT}`
17       );
18     });
19   } catch (error) {
20     console.error(
21       "Server startup error:",
22       error.message
23     );
24   }
25 }
26
27
28 startServer();
```

2. Gateway Express Setup (src/app.js)



```
1 import express from "express";
2 import cors from "cors";
3
4 import authRoutes
5   from "./routes/authRoutes.js";
6
7 import faqRoutes
8   from "./routes/faqRouter.js";
9
10 import aiRoutes
11   from "./routes/aiRoutes.js";
12
13 import errorMiddleware
14   from "./middleware/errorMiddleware.js";
15
16
17 const app = express();
18
19
20
21 // Middleware
22 app.use(cors());
23
24 app.use(express.json());
25
26
27 // Home
28 app.get("/", (req, res) => {
29   res.status(200).json({
30     message:
31       "FAQ AI Assistant API is running"
```

3. Security Access Middleware

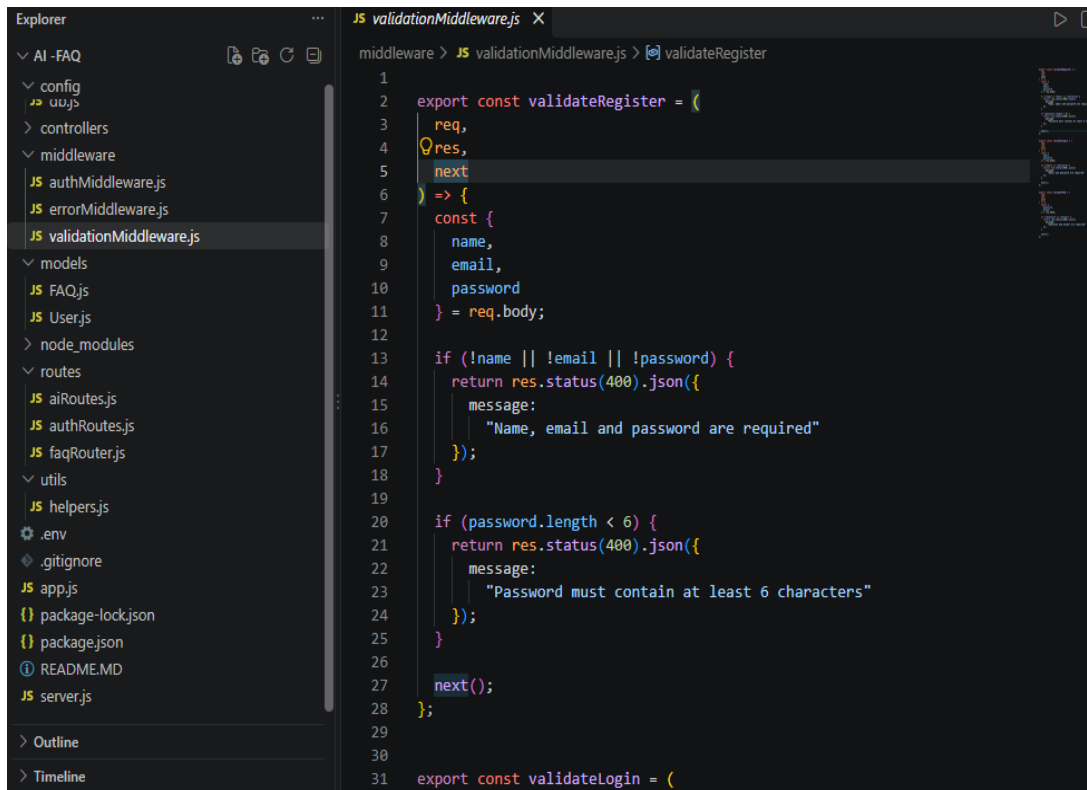
(src/middleware/authMiddleware.js)

Intercepts incoming target queries, extracts transmission header authorization records, and validates token identity context claims:

The image shows a code editor with a file explorer on the left and a code editor on the right. The file explorer shows a project structure with folders like 'config', 'controllers', 'middleware', 'models', 'routes', and 'utils'. The 'middleware' folder is expanded, and 'authMiddleware.js' is selected. The code editor shows the implementation of the 'authMiddleware' function, which uses 'jsonwebtoken' to verify a JWT token and sets the 'req.user' property.

```
1 import jwt from "jsonwebtoken";
2
3 const authMiddleware = (
4   req,
5   res,
6   next
7 ) => {
8   try {
9     const authHeader =
10       req.headers.authorization;
11
12     if (!authHeader) {
13       return res.status(401).json({
14         message:
15           "Authorization token required"
16       });
17     }
18
19     const token =
20       authHeader.startsWith("Bearer ")
21       ? authHeader.split(" ")[1]
22       : authHeader;
23
24     const decoded = jwt.verify(
25       token,
26       process.env.JWT_SECRET
27     );
28
29     req.user = decoded;
30   } catch (error) {
31     // Handle JWT verification error
32   }
33   next();
34 }
```

4. Centralized Error Handler Middleware (src/middleware/errorMiddleware.js).



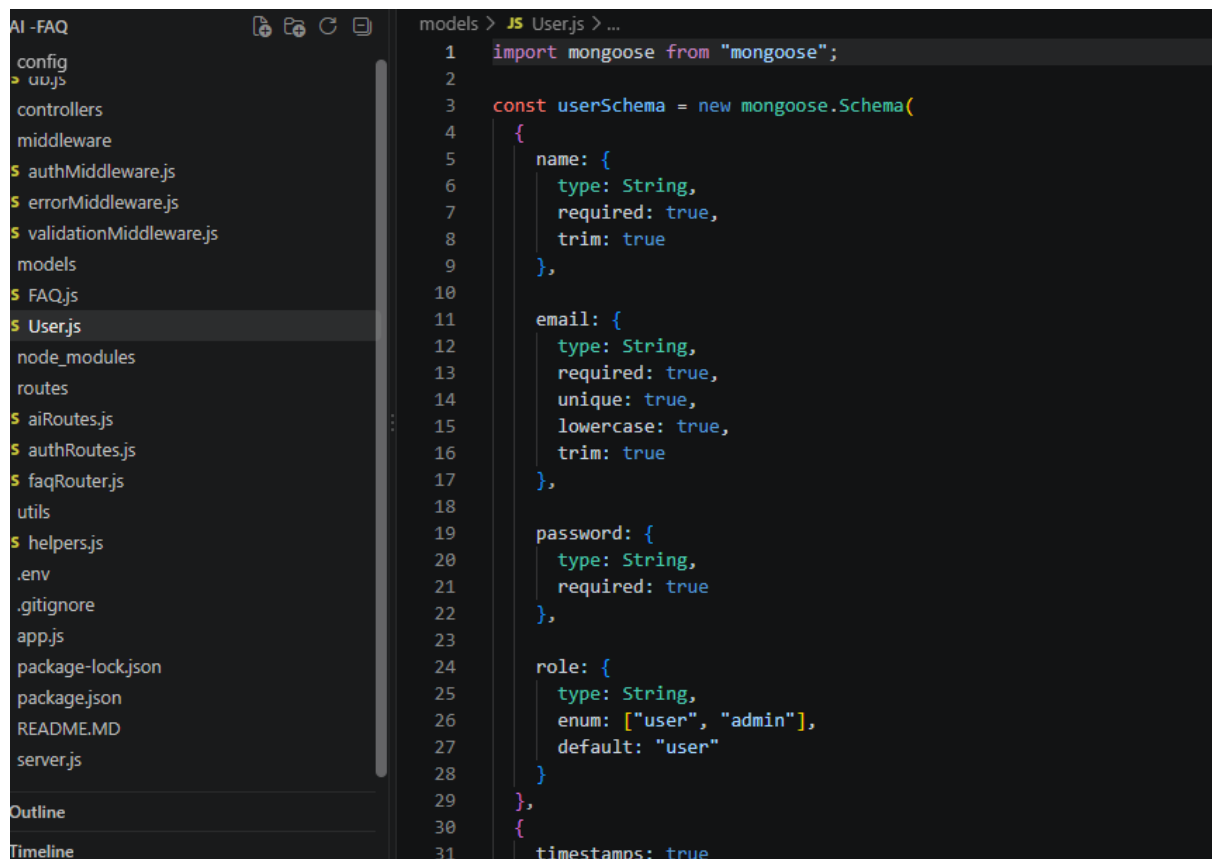
```
1
2 export const validateRegister = (
3   req,
4   res,
5   next
6 ) => {
7   const {
8     name,
9     email,
10    password
11  } = req.body;
12
13  if (!name || !email || !password) {
14    return res.status(400).json({
15      message:
16        "Name, email and password are required"
17    });
18  }
19
20  if (password.length < 6) {
21    return res.status(400).json({
22      message:
23        "Password must contain at least 6 characters"
24    });
25  }
26
27  next();
28 };
29
30
31 export const validateLogin = (
```

Epic 4: Database Configuration

Mongoose Schema Definitions

1. Identity Resource Document Schema (src/models/User.js)

Enforces profile field criteria validations and hooks password has to user document persistence:



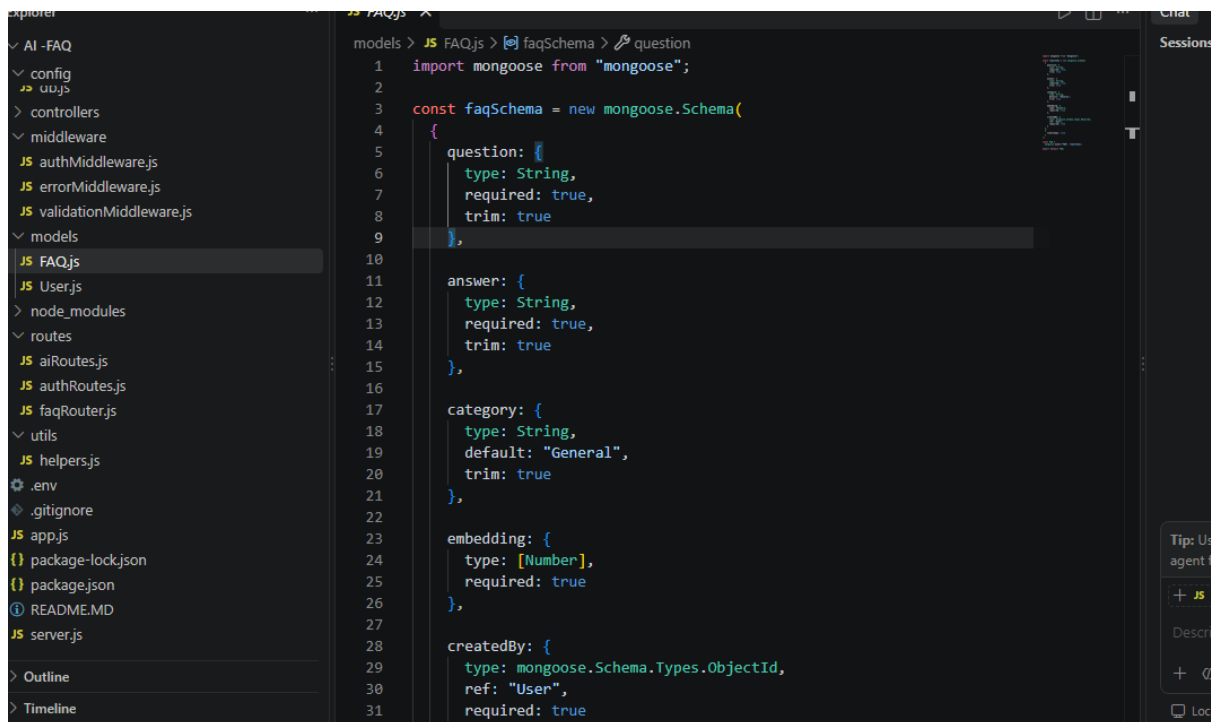
```
AI - FAQ
config
uv.js
controllers
middleware
$ authMiddleware.js
$ errorMiddleware.js
$ validationMiddleware.js
models
$ FAQ.js
$ User.js
node_modules
routes
$ aiRoutes.js
$ authRoutes.js
$ faqRouter.js
utils
$ helpers.js
.env
.gitignore
app.js
package-lock.json
package.json
README.MD
server.js

Outline
Timeline

models > JS User.js > ...
1  import mongoose from "mongoose";
2
3  const userSchema = new mongoose.Schema(
4  {
5      name: {
6          type: String,
7          required: true,
8          trim: true
9      },
10
11     email: {
12         type: String,
13         required: true,
14         unique: true,
15         lowercase: true,
16         trim: true
17     },
18
19     password: {
20         type: String,
21         required: true
22     },
23
24     role: {
25         type: String,
26         enum: ["user", "admin"],
27         default: "user"
28     }
29 },
30 {
31     timestamps: true
```

2. FAQ Resource Document Schema (src/models/FAQ.js)

Models core properties and maps a distinct relational reference link back to the source creator document:

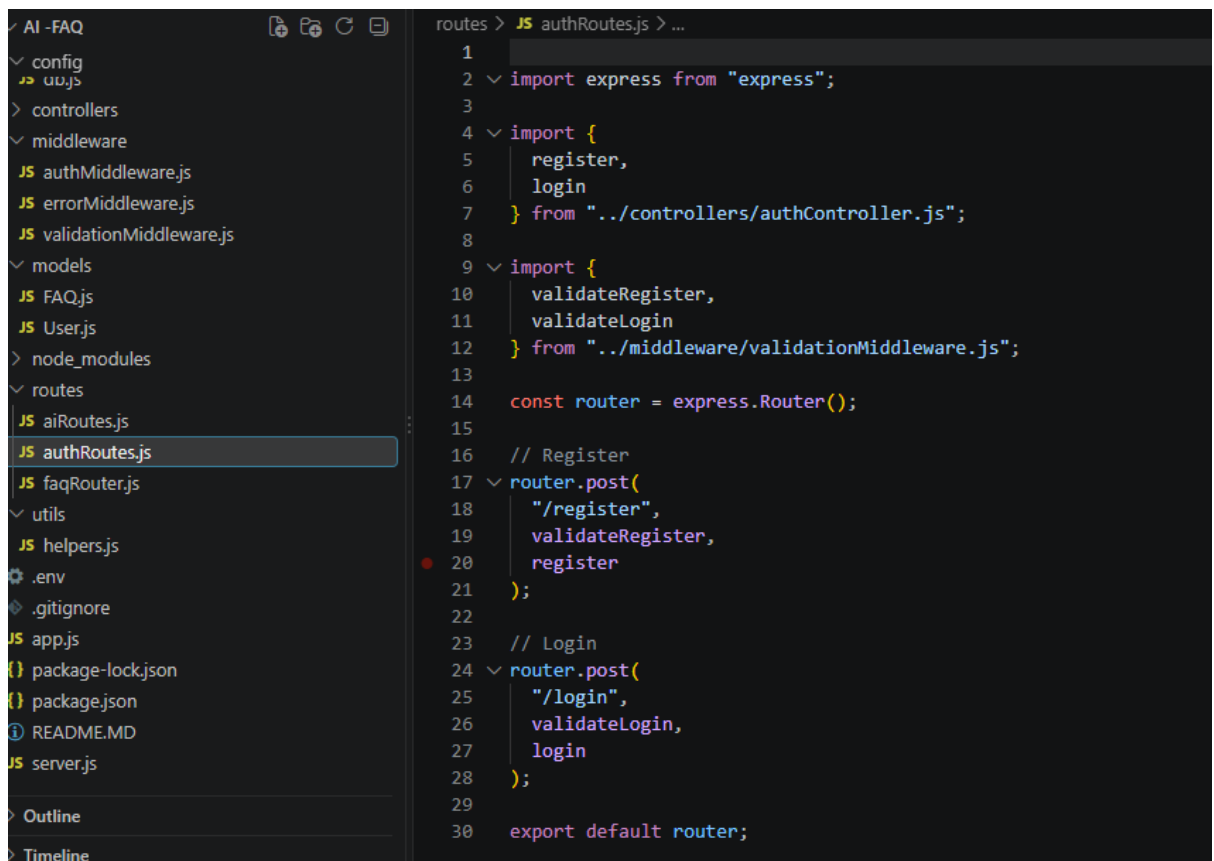


The screenshot shows a code editor with a file explorer on the left and a code editor on the right. The file explorer shows a project structure with folders like 'config', 'controllers', 'middleware', 'models', 'routes', and 'utils'. The 'models' folder is expanded, showing 'FAQ.js' selected. The code editor shows the following code:

```
1 import mongoose from "mongoose";
2
3 const faqSchema = new mongoose.Schema(
4   {
5     question: {
6       type: String,
7       required: true,
8       trim: true
9     },
10
11     answer: {
12       type: String,
13       required: true,
14       trim: true
15     },
16
17     category: {
18       type: String,
19       default: "General",
20       trim: true
21     },
22
23     embedding: {
24       type: [Number],
25       required: true
26     },
27
28     createdBy: {
29       type: mongoose.Schema.Types.ObjectId,
30       ref: "User",
31       required: true
32     }
33   }
34 );
```

API Router Interface Endpoints

1. Public Authentication Operations (src/routes/authRoutes.js)

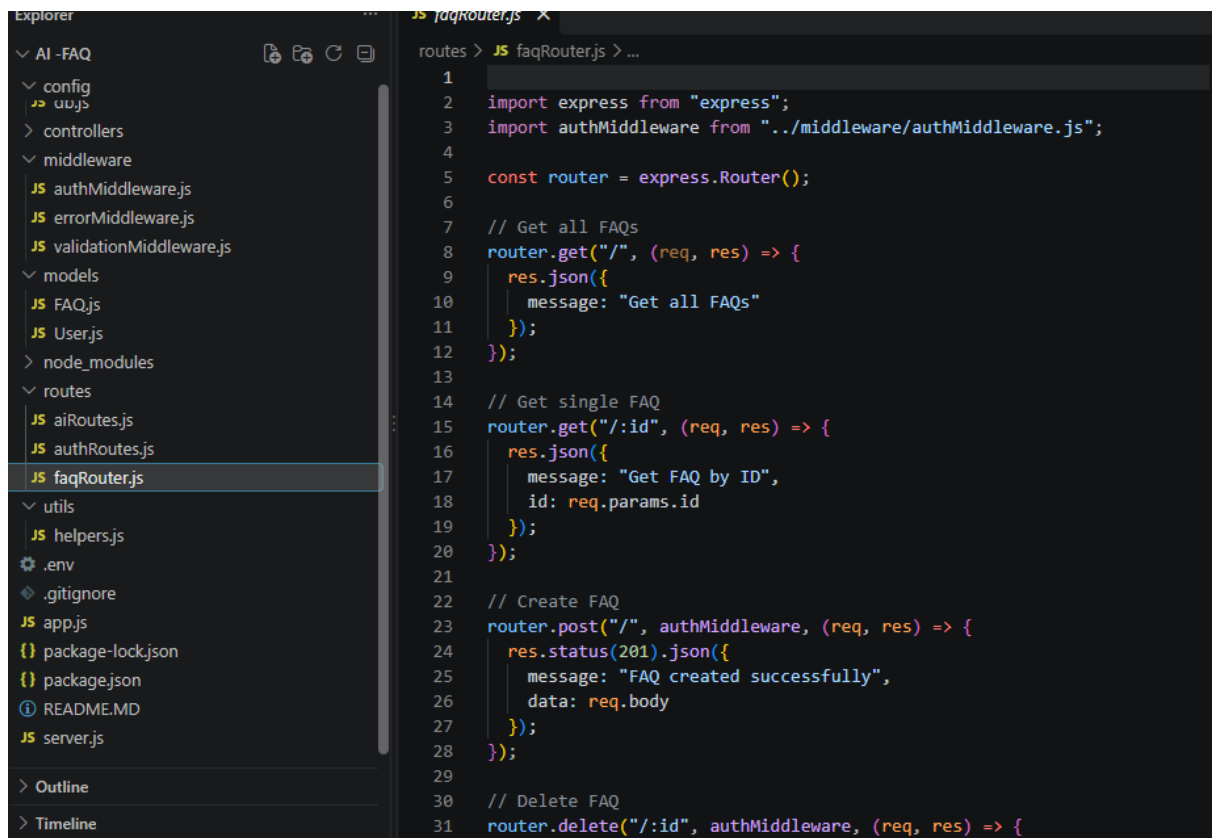


The image shows a code editor interface. On the left is a file explorer with a tree view containing the following items: AI -FAQ, config, uv.js, controllers, middleware (with sub-items authMiddleware.js, errorMiddleware.js, and validationMiddleware.js), models (with sub-items FAQ.js and User.js), node_modules, routes (with sub-items aiRoutes.js, authRoutes.js (highlighted), and faqRouter.js), utils (with sub-item helpers.js), .env, .gitignore, app.js, package-lock.json, package.json, README.MD, server.js, Outline, and Timeline. On the right, the code for routes/authRoutes.js is displayed, showing imports for express, register, login, validateRegister, and validateLogin, the creation of an express router, and the definition of POST routes for /register and /login.

```
1
2 import express from "express";
3
4 import {
5   register,
6   login
7 } from "../controllers/authController.js";
8
9 import {
10   validateRegister,
11   validateLogin
12 } from "../middleware/validationMiddleware.js";
13
14 const router = express.Router();
15
16 // Register
17 router.post(
18   "/register",
19   validateRegister,
20   register
21 );
22
23 // Login
24 router.post(
25   "/login",
26   validateLogin,
27   login
28 );
29
30 export default router;
```

2.Protected FAQ Operations

(src/routes/faqRoutes.js) JavaScript

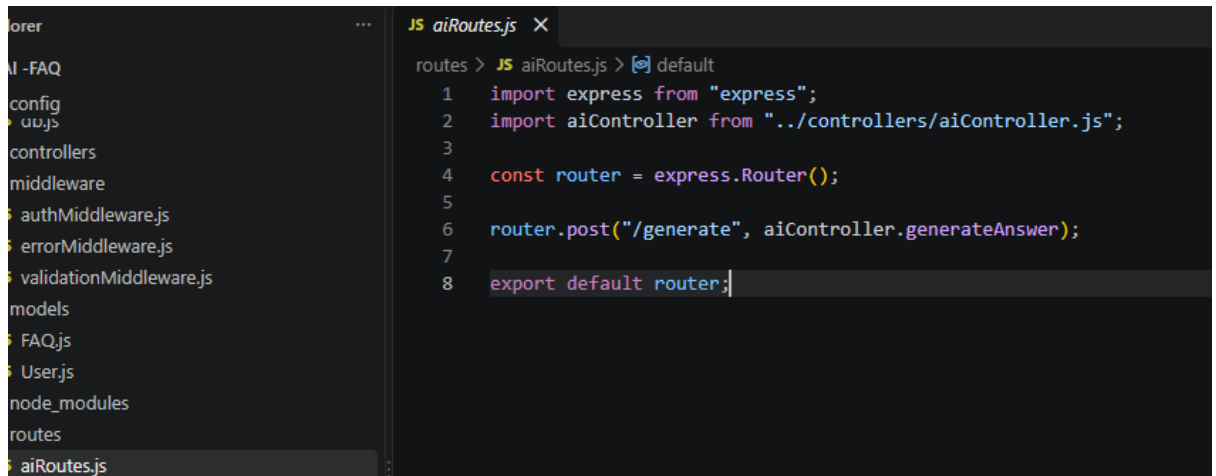


The image shows a screenshot of a code editor (VS Code) with a file explorer on the left and a code editor on the right. The file explorer shows a project structure with folders like 'AI -FAQ', 'config', 'controllers', 'middleware', 'models', 'node_modules', 'routes', 'utils', and files like 'app.js', 'package-lock.json', 'package.json', 'README.MD', and 'server.js'. The 'faqRouter.js' file is selected in the 'routes' folder. The code editor shows the content of 'faqRouter.js', which includes imports for 'express' and 'authMiddleware', and defines a 'router' using 'express.Router()'. It contains three routes: a GET route for '/', a GET route for '/:id', and a POST route for '/' (protected by 'authMiddleware').

```
1 import express from "express";
2 import authMiddleware from "../middleware/authMiddleware.js";
3
4 const router = express.Router();
5
6 // Get all FAQs
7 router.get("/", (req, res) => {
8   res.json({
9     message: "Get all FAQs"
10  });
11 });
12
13 // Get single FAQ
14 router.get("/:id", (req, res) => {
15   res.json({
16     message: "Get FAQ by ID",
17     id: req.params.id
18   });
19 });
20
21 // Create FAQ
22 router.post("/", authMiddleware, (req, res) => {
23   res.status(201).json({
24     message: "FAQ created successfully",
25     data: req.body
26   });
27 });
28
29 // Delete FAQ
30 router.delete("/:id", authMiddleware, (req, res) => {
```

3.AI Automation Operations

(src/routes/aiRoutes.js)



```
1 import express from "express";
2 import aiController from "../controllers/aiController.js";
3
4 const router = express.Router();
5
6 router.post("/generate", aiController.generateAnswer);
7
8 export default router;
```

Epic 5: Project Executions

Running the API Application

- Install Postman or Thunder Client (VS Code extension).
- Start the backend development server environment parameters:

Bash

```
npm run dev
```

API Testing Specification Demo

To verify operational structural integrity via execution endpoints, map endpoints using the configurations below:

1. Identity Onboarding Path Registration

Route: POST/api/auth/register

Access: Public

Payload Request Body JSON:

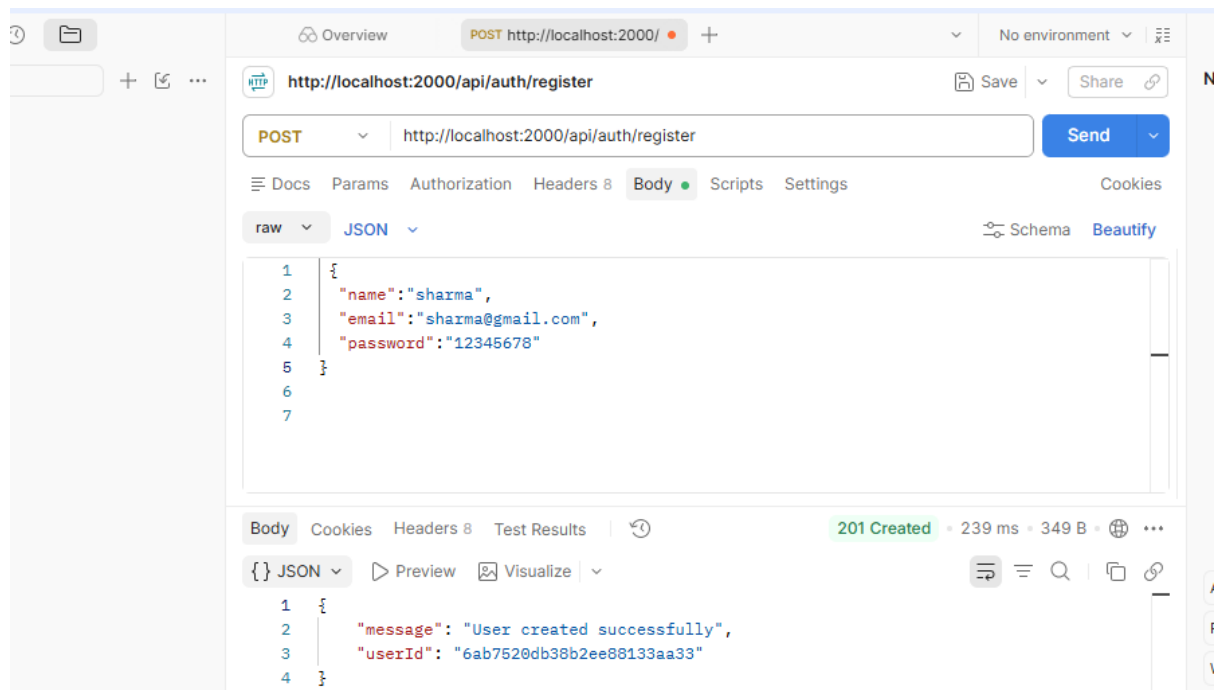
JSON

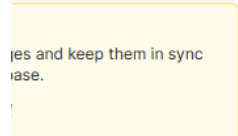
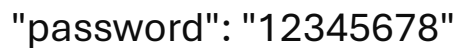
```
}
```

"name": "Sharma",

"email": "sharma@gmail.com",

"password": "12345678"





3. Resource Entity Creation (FAQ)

Route: POST/api/faqs

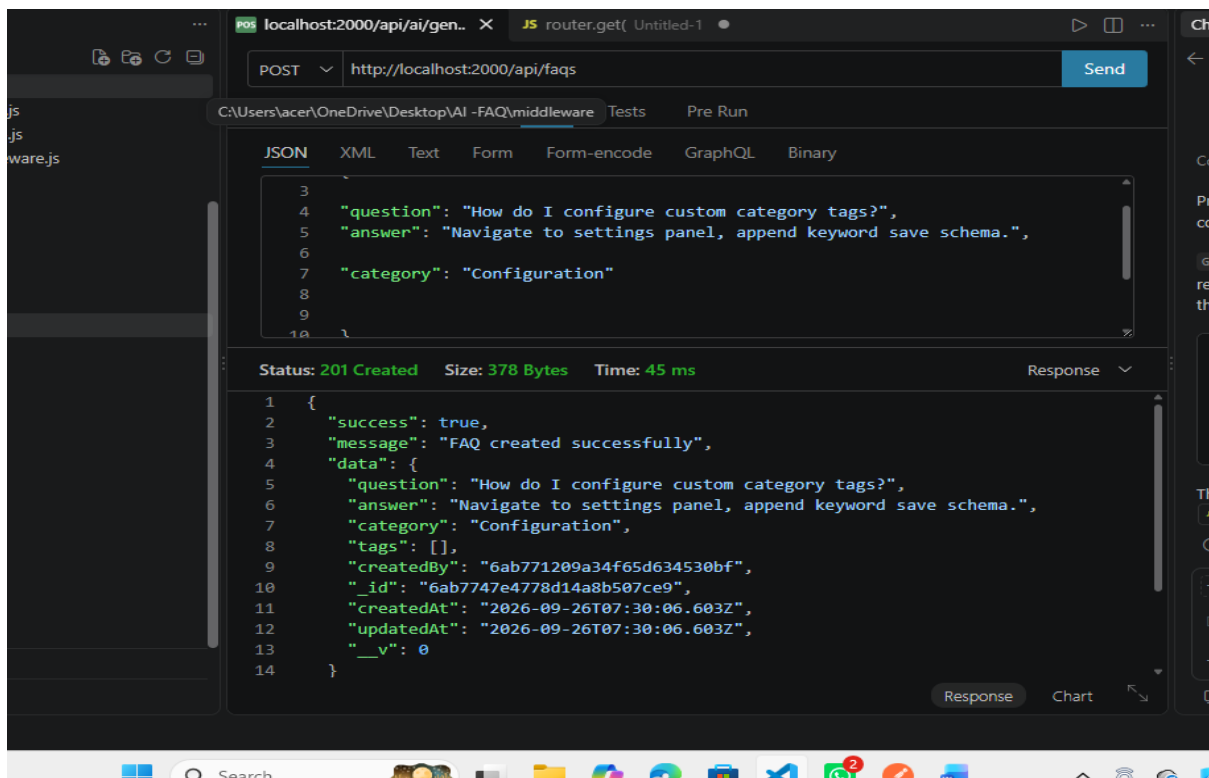
Access: Private (Bearer <JWT Token>)

Payload Request Body JSON:

tags arrays, and

JSON

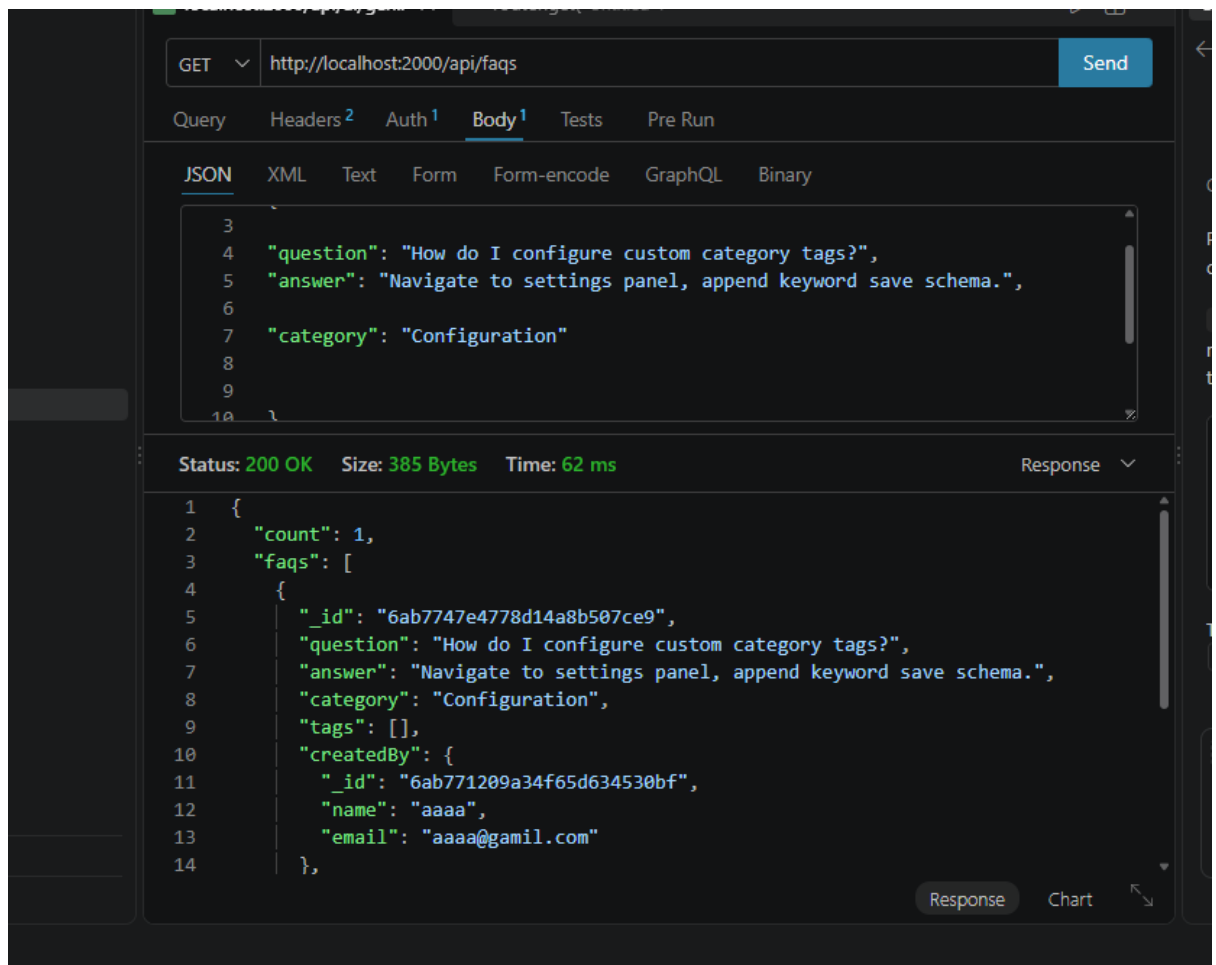
```
"question": "How do I configure custom category tags?",  
"answer": "Navigate to settings panel, append keyword save schema.",  
"category": "Configuration"
```



4. Keyword Resource Entity Fetching (Search)

Route: GET/api/faqs/search=configure

Access: Public



5. AI Intelligent Content Automation (Generate FAQ Pair)

Route: POST /api/ai/generate-faq

Access: Private (Bearer <JWT Token>)

Payload Request Body JSON

JSON

```
{  
  "topic": "mongoose schema index validation runtime workflow  
  optimization"  
}
```

API&DEMO link:

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1eeicJeiXL2fzdQnAjcZPq2JKwrAPzXuc>

CODE DRIVE: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1pX7-z9odjtqhNIX95vrMsCgY0d12kaef?usp=drive_link